

Learning to Trust - The Making of “Raya and the Last Dragon”

Kyle Odermatt

Walt Disney Animation Studios
USA

Larry Wu

Walt Disney Animation Studios
USA

Carlos Cabral

Walt Disney Animation Studios
USA

Rob Dressel

Walt Disney Animation Studios
USA

Michael Kaschalk

Walt Disney Animation Studios
USA

Adolf Lusinsky

Walt Disney Animation Studios
USA



ABSTRACT

What are the mysterious Druun? How can enemies from different parts of a vast world learn to trust each other again? In Walt Disney Animation Studios’ “Raya and the Last Dragon,” our protagonist first breaks the world and then leads us on a journey in search of a magical solution to heal it.

In this session, our filmmakers show how they collaboratively crafted the extensive lands of Kumandra and filled them with distinctive characters and detail that represent a compelling mix of fantasy and Southeast Asian influences. We’ll reveal the challenge of creating a brood of magical water dragons that rippled through multiple departments. Creating a nemesis for the dragons unlike anything seen before was another task for our effects and lighting departments. All shot through the lens of a story-enhancing cinematography plan that considered every detail right down to the dramatic film grain, all while working from home.

Please unite with us as we detail our collaborative filmmaking process.

ACM Reference Format:

Kyle Odermatt, Larry Wu, Carlos Cabral, Rob Dressel, Michael Kaschalk, and Adolf Lusinsky. 2021. Learning to Trust - The Making of “Raya and the Last Dragon”. In *Proceedings of SIGGRAPH ’21 Production Sessions*. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 1 page. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3446368.3451987>

Permission to make digital or hard copies of part or all of this work for personal or classroom use is granted without fee provided that copies are not made or distributed for profit or commercial advantage and that copies bear this notice and the full citation on the first page. Copyrights for third-party components of this work must be honored. For all other uses, contact the owner/author(s).

SIGGRAPH ’21 Production Sessions, August 01-05, 2021, Virtual Event, USA

© 2021 Copyright held by the owner/author(s).

ACM ISBN 978-1-4503-8322-6/21/08.

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3446368.3451987>